

Most wired economy!

In a study by World economic forum, Sweden and Singapore top the digital competitiveness of nations index

Playstation network down

Millions of players are out of the Playstation network as it suffered its own fail whale for more than 20 hours

OPTIONS FOR WP7 DEVICES TODAY

HTC, Samsung and LG did jump on to the WP7 bandwagon almost as soon as WP7 was announced. Dell joined the party lately with their premium Dell Venue Pro offering. So, if you are betting big on the WP7 platform and are itching to spend some of your bank balance on a shiny new WP7 phone, here are your options in the Indian market currently.

1) HTC HD7

Buy for: Big, 4.3-inch screen, good build quality, capable hardware

Watch for: Clunky and heavy handset, camera quality isn't great

Pricing: ₹27,000

2) Dell Venue Pro

Buy for: Slide-out physical QWERTY keypad, 4.1-inch high resolution screen,

Watch for: poor

camera performance, heavy device

Pricing: ₹28,500

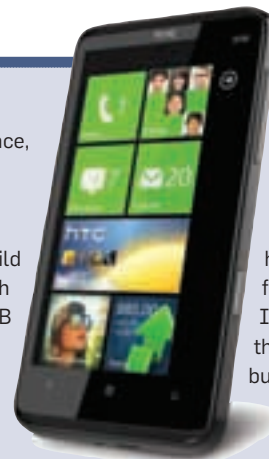
3) HTC Mozart 7

Buy for: Great build quality, xenon flash

Watch for: only 8GB storage

Pricing: ₹25,500

The Samsung Omnia 7 and LG Optimus 7



were seen in the grey market, but their official presence in the market is doubtful and hence you might find some eBay India sellers offering these handsets but they will not be backed by official warranty.

Takes work seriously

The office integration and implementation on Windows Phone 7 is unsurprisingly brilliant. You'd obviously expect WP7 to give you the best possible office experience and so it does. Right from the ability to view all common office documents to editing them and managing them, the process is much better compared to any smartphone platform today. The editing options are pretty basic though, you can only change font colors, format them and highlight text.

The "OneNote", note taking application is quite a gem, it lets you attach photos or record audio clips along with the notes and they can be synced to your Windows Live account so you can access them from anywhere through the cloud service.

Browsing is another area where WP7 scores very high, while the browser itself is not blazing fast, it is pretty stable and behaves well across all applications. Be it pinch and zoom, font rendering and page alignment, script rendering and flash performance. The experience is largely smooth and glitch-free.



device to make it look, feel and function differently, WP7 will make you feel very cramped. The interface is more or less fixed and unlike the Google Android OS, you cannot customise WP7 to make it sing to your tunes. Heck! You can't even add a custom ringtone! Microsoft being Microsoft, gives you very little headroom to tweak the OS as per your requirements, unless there is an update from Redmond, you are more or less stuck with the same interface with very few settings that can be accessed to customise the OS. In this Android age; micromanagement of apps, tweaking the settings for performance boost, being able to "kill" a task and adding a custom app to manage vital statistics of your device is perhaps not too much to ask for. But, for Micro-

The office interface that you are so used to on your PC platform, no reason to complain here.



soft, it's my way or the highway for now.

App Support

Weak app support is WP7's Achilles Heel today; the app ecosystem (Windows Phone7 Marketplace) is nowhere close to Android Market and the Apple App store. One would assume that, Microsoft with all their muscle and clout would be able to pull-in developers to churn out apps and flood the market place. But, the

restrictions of a closed platform coupled with stringent requirements and guidelines for app developers is pulling WP7 down in terms of the sheer number of apps, quality of apps and also the overall developer interest. The fact is, if ever Microsoft manages to match the competition in terms of variety and availability of apps, it is not happening any time soon. Also, unlike Android, one cannot expect a lot of free apps featuring on the WP7 Market Place. So if you are one of those who lives and breathes apps, WP7 surely will not catch your fancy for now.

Microsoft Centric

For obvious reasons, WP7 will push Microsoft services above all others and that isn't necessarily a bad thing. But, if you associate the word "google" with search, mail and maps, the support on WP7 for these Google services isn't exactly stellar. The default universal search on WP7 is Microsoft Bing, the default browser is Internet Explorer and the default GPS application is tied to Bing Maps. Let's take Bing maps for example, it is nowhere close to Google Maps (which is getting smarter with every update) and you cannot install Google Maps on a WP7 device as of now. Even if one does see the arrival of Google Maps on the WP7, it probably will be a crippled and very basic version.

Even when it comes to device management Windows Phone 7 device is locked to the Zune software, which acts as a door keeper for most of the interaction. So, when you are buying into WP7 as a platform, you are essentially agreeing to live by the Microsoft

THE BAD

Not for customisation

If you are the experimental kind, always trying to tweak and customise your